TikTok Recommendation Lesson Teaching Script

MCCP6010 | Group 6 | 15 minute classroom lesson

Read the SAY text aloud. Carry out each highlighted instruction immediately after the spoken sentence above it. Yellow background with red text identifies presenter actions; these instructions are not spoken. Every Right keypress advances exactly one Part, including the boundary between two numbered pages.

Manual countdowns

The lesson clock and all three activity timers wait for a click. Click Start to begin, Pause to stop, and Resume to continue. Leaving an activity Part pauses that activity; returning waits for another click. Reset restores its duration and waits. The 15 minute lesson clock continues across pages after you start it.

BEFORE CLASS: OPEN the online lesson or local For_You_Group6.html. PRESS Home, then F. Keep the cover at 01 - Part 1 and the lesson clock at 15:00. Prepare Kahoot in a second tab; add separate host and participant links in Presentation settings if available.

Running order

Lesson clock	Lead	Web page and Parts
Before class	A	01 Part 1 cover
00:00 to 02:00	A	02 Parts 1 to 4 and 03 Parts 1 to 2
02:00 to 04:00	B	04 Parts 1 to 4 user signals
04:00 to 06:00	B	05 Parts 1 to 4 content and shared interests
06:00 to 07:00	C	06 Parts 1 to 6 classroom rule
07:00 to 09:00	C	07 Parts 1 to 3 pair challenge
09:00 to 10:00	C	08 Parts 1 to 7 answer and reasoning
10:00 to 11:00	D	09 Parts 1 to 7 feedback update
11:00 to 13:00	D	10 Parts 1 to 5 diversity and discussion
13:00 to 15:00	D	11 quiz and takeaways

Elapsed times are rehearsal targets measured from clicking the lesson clock. The script includes student responses, handovers, activity time and the final question. Keep pair work at 60 seconds and the final discussion at 40 seconds.

Member A Opening and learning goals

01 - Part 1 Cover

Before the clock starts

SAY Let's begin.
[PRESS RIGHT once to 02 - Part 1. Then CLICK the 15:00 lesson timer marked Start, immediately before the next spoken line.]

02 - Part 1 Compare the two feeds

00:00 to 00:10

SAY Hi everyone, we're Group Six. Take a look at Alex and Jamie. They are using the same app.
[PRESS RIGHT once to 02 - Part 2.]

02 - Part 2 Different feeds

00:10 to 00:25

SAY Alex mostly sees pet videos, while Jamie sees fitness videos. What clues might explain the difference? Have a quick think, then share one idea with your partner.
[PRESS RIGHT once to 02 - Part 3.]

02 - Part 3 Partner discussion

00:25 to 00:55

SAY You have fifteen seconds. Start now.
[CLICK the activity timer marked Start. Stay on 02 - Part 3 for the full 15 seconds. Do not speak over the discussion.]

SAY Let's hear from one pair. What do you think the app noticed?
[WAIT for one short response.]

SAY Thanks. Different clues can lead to different predictions.
[PRESS RIGHT once to 02 - Part 4.]

02 - Part 4 Bridge to the learning journey

00:55 to 01:00

SAY Let's follow those clues to the next video.
[PRESS RIGHT once to 03 - Part 1.]

03 - Part 1 The four steps

01:00 to 01:25

SAY The system collects clues, works out what the content is about, ranks possible videos, and updates its predictions as we watch. Let's see what we can learn from that journey.
[PRESS RIGHT once to 03 - Part 2.]

03 - Part 2 The three learning goals

01:25 to 02:00

SAY Today, we'll recognize clues in our actions and in the videos, use a simple rule to rank videos and explain our choice, and see how new feedback can change the feed. What does the app actually notice while we're watching?
[PRESS RIGHT once to 04 - Part 1. HAND OVER to B after advancing.]

Member B User signals and content

04 - Part 1 Two kinds of user signals

02:00 to 02:12

SAY Every time we watch or interact with a video, we leave clues. Some are deliberate; others come from how we watch.
[PRESS RIGHT once to 04 - Part 2.]

04 - Part 2 Explicit and implicit feedback

02:12 to 03:00

SAY A Like, a share or a follow is an explicit signal: we're deliberately interacting with the content. Watch time, skipping and rewatching are implicit signals. Even without pressing Like, how we watch can still provide evidence of interest.

SAY Can you name one explicit signal and one implicit signal?
[TAKE one short answer. If needed, SAY: A Like is explicit; watch time is implicit.]

SAY Now let's compare two viewers.
[PRESS RIGHT once to 04 - Part 3.]

04 - Part 3 Signals need context

03:00 to 03:30

SAY Viewer A taps Like, then skips after two seconds. Viewer B never taps Like but watches to the end. Which viewer seems more interested? What else would you need to know?
[TAKE one or two short reasons. Keep the takeaway unrevealed.]

SAY Let's put those clues together.
[PRESS RIGHT once to 04 - Part 4.]

04 - Part 4 Interpret signals together

03:30 to 04:00

SAY The Like tells us one thing, and viewing time tells us another. Video length and viewing context matter too. We interpret the clues together. Those are clues about the viewer. What can we learn about the video itself?
[PRESS RIGHT once to 05 - Part 1.]

05 - Part 1 Look for content clues

04:00 to 04:25

SAY Take this kitten video. What clues in the picture, the words or the sound could help a system work out what it's about?
[TAKE one or two short answers before revealing the labels.]

SAY Let's name the clues.
[PRESS RIGHT once to 05 - Part 2.]

05 - Part 2 Name the content clues

04:25 to 04:55

SAY The topic is pets or cats. The title, hashtags and sound add detail. User behavior tells us what someone does; content information describes the video. We can also use clues from people with similar interests.
[PRESS RIGHT once to 05 - Part 3.]

05 - Part 3 Shared interests

04:55 to 05:35

SAY Alex and Jamie both interacted with videos one and two. Jamie also liked video three. Might Alex enjoy video three as well? Why?
[TAKE one short prediction and reason. Keep Alex's candidate slot unrevealed.]

SAY Their shared interests give us a reason to try it.
[PRESS RIGHT once to 05 - Part 4.]

05 - Part 4 Suggest a candidate

05:35 to 06:00

SAY Video three becomes a candidate: a video we might show Alex next. It is a prediction, not a guarantee. So, which candidate should come first?
[PRESS RIGHT once to 06 - Part 1. HAND OVER to C after advancing.]

Member C Ranking rule and pair work

06 - Part 1 Compare possible videos

06:00 to 06:05

SAY How could we combine different clues to choose the next video?
[PRESS RIGHT once to 06 - Part 2.]

06 - Part 2 Introduce the classroom rule

06:05 to 06:25

SAY Interest Match describes how well a video fits inferred interests. Predicted Engagement estimates watching or interaction. Both supplied ratings go from one to five. In our classroom rule, we double Interest Match, then add Predicted Engagement.
[PRESS RIGHT once to 06 - Part 3.]

06 - Part 3 Read the supplied ratings

06:25 to 06:34

SAY Here, Interest Match is three and Predicted Engagement is two. Let's substitute those values.
[PRESS RIGHT once to 06 - Part 4.]

06 - Part 4 Substitute

06:34 to 06:42

SAY Our calculation is two times three, plus two. We multiply first.
[PRESS RIGHT once to 06 - Part 5.]

06 - Part 5 Multiply

06:42 to 06:49

SAY Doubling three gives six. Now add two.
[PRESS RIGHT once to 06 - Part 6.]

06 - Part 6 Complete the example

06:49 to 07:00

SAY Six plus two gives a score of eight. This is a simplified classroom model, not TikTok's actual formula. Now try it yourselves.
[PRESS RIGHT once to 07 - Part 1.]

07 - Part 1 Read the candidate ratings

07:00 to 07:25

SAY Here are three candidate videos for Alex. We've supplied both ratings for each one. The recent viewing history provides context; you do not need to derive the ratings from it. Use the supplied numbers to decide the order.
[PRESS RIGHT once to 07 - Part 2.]

07 - Part 2 Explain the pair task

07:25 to 08:00

SAY Work with the person next to you. Calculate each score, put all three videos in order, and prepare a because sentence. Use the same rule for all three cards. You will have one minute. Ready?
[PRESS RIGHT once to 07 - Part 3.]

07 - Part 3 One minute pair challenge

08:00 to 09:00

SAY Start now.
[CLICK the activity timer marked Start. Keep 07 - Part 3 and its hidden answers on screen. Read the next line when 00:15 remains.]

SAY About fifteen seconds left. Agree on your order and one reason.
[SAY this only when 00:15 remains. WAIT until the timer reaches 00:00.]

SAY Let's compare your rankings.
[PRESS RIGHT once to 08 - Part 1.]

Member C Ranking answers and reasons

08 - Part 1 Hear a ranking before revealing answers

09:00 to 09:10

SAY Which video did you put first, and why?
[TAKE one pair's ranking and reason before revealing any calculation.]

SAY Let's check Pets first.
[PRESS RIGHT once to 08 - Part 2.]

08 - Part 2 Substitute for Pets

09:10 to 09:17

SAY For Pets, we double four and add three. Multiply first.
[PRESS RIGHT once to 08 - Part 3.]

08 - Part 3 Multiply the match rating

09:17 to 09:23

SAY Doubling four gives eight. Now add three.
[PRESS RIGHT once to 08 - Part 4.]

08 - Part 4 Complete the Pets score

09:23 to 09:28

SAY Eight plus three gives eleven. Let's check the other two totals.
[PRESS RIGHT once to 08 - Part 5.]

08 - Part 5 Check the other scores

09:28 to 09:35

SAY Fitness scores nine and Cooking eight. Now compare all three scores.
[PRESS RIGHT once to 08 - Part 6.]

08 - Part 6 Rank and justify

09:35 to 09:50

SAY The order is Pets, Fitness, Cooking. Fitness has the highest Predicted Engagement rating. Why isn't it first?
[TAKE one short reason before showing the explanation.]

SAY Let's check the explanation.
[PRESS RIGHT once to 08 - Part 7.]

08 - Part 7 Explain the combined total

09:50 to 10:00

SAY Our model compares the combined weighted total. Pets scores eleven, above Fitness at nine. Now let's see what happens when Alex watches something new.
[PRESS RIGHT once to 09 - Part 1. HAND OVER to D after advancing.]

Member D Feedback and diversity

09 - Part 1 A new cooking video

10:00 to 10:04

SAY Let's see what one new action might change.
[PRESS RIGHT once to 09 - Part 2.]

09 - Part 2 A completed view

10:04 to 10:10

SAY Alex watches this cooking video to the end. That gives us a fresh clue.
[PRESS RIGHT once to 09 - Part 3.]

09 - Part 3 Ask before updating

10:10 to 10:23

SAY What might happen to Cooking's position? Why?
[TAKE one short prediction before revealing the updated value.]

SAY Let's update our classroom example.
[PRESS RIGHT once to 09 - Part 4.]

09 - Part 4 Update Interest Match

10:23 to 10:32

SAY For this simulation, Cooking's Interest Match rises from three to five. Predicted Engagement stays at two. Use the same rule.
[PRESS RIGHT once to 09 - Part 5.]

09 - Part 5 Substitute the new values

10:32 to 10:39

SAY Two times five, plus two. Multiply first.
[PRESS RIGHT once to 09 - Part 6.]

09 - Part 6 Multiply

10:39 to 10:45

SAY Doubling five gives ten. Now add two.
[PRESS RIGHT once to 09 - Part 7.]

09 - Part 7 Update the ranking

10:45 to 11:00

SAY The new score is twelve, so Cooking now ranks above Pets at eleven and Fitness at nine. New evidence can change a prediction. The exact numerical update is part of our simulation. What if the feed keeps making similar choices?
[PRESS RIGHT once to 10 - Part 1.]

10 - Part 1 A mixed feed

11:00 to 11:10

SAY This feed begins with a mix of topics. Watch what happens when similar recommendations repeat.
[PRESS RIGHT once to 10 - Part 2.]

10 - Part 2 More of the same

11:10 to 11:40

SAY What is becoming less visible? What might Alex miss?
[TAKE one brief response.]

SAY Repeated personalization may reduce exposure to other topics and viewpoints. That is a possible filter-bubble risk. A feed can also make room for exploration.
[PRESS RIGHT once to 10 - Part 3.]

10 - Part 3 Exploration

11:40 to 12:00

SAY Other topics can help us discover something new. We can influence the clues too. If your feed were full of pet videos, what action would you try, and why? Let's think, pair and share.
[PRESS RIGHT once to 10 - Part 4.]

10 - Part 4 Think pair share

12:00 to 12:40

SAY Take five seconds to think on your own.
[CLICK the activity timer marked Start. Remain on 10 - Part 4 for all 40 seconds. WAIT for PAIR before the next spoken line.]

SAY Now share your idea with your partner.
[Stay on this Part. Allow 20 seconds and WAIT for SHARE before the next spoken line.]

SAY Let's hear one idea. What would you do, and why?
[TAKE one action and reason during the final 15 seconds. WAIT for 00:00 before the next spoken line.]

SAY Thanks. Here are some ways to influence the feed.
[PRESS RIGHT once to 10 - Part 5.]

10 - Part 5 Feed controls

12:40 to 13:00

SAY You can use Not Interested, adjust topic preferences, or explore other content. These actions provide different clues; they do not guarantee an immediate change to the whole feed. Let's check what we've learned.
[PRESS RIGHT once to 11 - Part 1. D continues with the quiz, takeaways and questions after advancing.]

Member D Quiz takeaways and questions

13:00 to 15:00 | D leads this complete section

11 - Part 1 Prepared Kahoot quiz

13:00 to 14:20

SAY Let's finish with three quick questions.
[CLICK Open in Kahoot on 11 - Part 1. Launch the prepared game in Kahoot and display its live PIN or participant QR code. Keep this lesson tab open. D hosts the quiz and monitors the lesson clock.]

SAY Join with the PIN or QR code. We'll begin now.
[Allow joining until 13:15. If the game is unavailable, ask the same three questions from the question bank orally while remaining on 11 - Part 1. Follow the same timings and answer key.]

SAY First, which actions tell us something about the viewer?
[At 13:15, START Q1 with a 10 second answer window, then reveal the answer.]

SAY A: watching and liking are things the viewer does.

SAY Now apply our rule to a new set of ratings.
[At 13:35, START Q2 with a 20 second answer window, then reveal the answer.]

SAY Music has eight, Sports seven and Movies six. Music ranks first.

SAY Finally, what happens when we get a new clue?
[At 14:00, START Q3 with a 15 second answer window, then reveal the answer.]

SAY B: new behavior provides evidence that may update predictions.
[At 14:20, RETURN to 11 - Part 1. PRESS RIGHT once to 11 - Part 2, the takeaways.]

11 - Part 2 Takeaways and questions

14:20 to 15:00

SAY Think back to Alex and Jamie. Their actions left different clues. The system used those clues to rank videos, then updated its predictions with new feedback.

SAY Before we finish, does anyone have one quick question?
[D takes one short question and answers it in one sentence. If there is no question, ask whether the system can learn without a Like; confirm that viewing behavior can also provide clues.]

SAY Thanks for joining us today.
[FINISH by 15:00. Do not advance again.]

Question bank and rehearsal checks

Q1 User behavior signals

Which pair contains TWO user behavior signals?

A Watching to the end and pressing Like
B A hashtag and the video's soundtrack
C A video title and its topic
D The caption and creator's country
Correct answer A. Kahoot answer window 10 seconds.

Q2 Weighted ranking

Score = 2 × Interest Match + Predicted Engagement. Which video ranks first?

A Sports Match 2 Engagement 3
B Music Match 3 Engagement 2
C Movies Match 1 Engagement 4
D All three have the same score
Correct answer B. Kahoot answer window 20 seconds.

Q3 Feedback

Why might recommendations change after a user watches a new topic?

A One action permanently fixes the user's interests
B New behavior provides evidence that may update interest predictions
C Every video in that topic must become the top result
D Content information stops being useful
Correct answer B. Kahoot answer window 15 seconds.

Rehearse these controls

PRESS O to choose an exact page and Part. PRESS LEFT to return to the previous Part; Right never skips a reveal. PRESS R only to reset the current activity or class choice; it does not return a scene to its first Part. To recover the quiz entrance, PRESS O and choose 11 - Part 1.

Use the model accurately

The classroom rule is Score = 2 × Interest Match + Predicted Engagement. Pets scores 11, Fitness 9 and Cooking 8. In the simulated update, Cooking's Match changes from 3 to 5, so its score becomes 12. The ratings and the update are supplied teaching examples, not TikTok's actual formula. Interpret signals in context and describe narrowing exposure as a possible risk. The two model inputs can draw on overlapping evidence.

Online lesson

https://xanderzhou2022.github.io/HKBU_MCCP6010_Why-does-TikTok-know-what-you-like/